

CASE STUDY

# Every claim moved at the speed of the hardest one.

They asked us to build a faster claims system to speed up processing. The scope: data entry was never the delay — simple, low-risk claims sat in the same queue as complex ones, waiting on manual triage, so the easy claims moved at the pace of the hard ones.

Real Problem

“Give us a faster claims system — our processing is too slow.”

Scope

Speed wasn't a typing problem, it was a decision problem. A cracked windscreen queued behind a total loss. Nothing cleared itself.

## 01. The Situation

A short-term insurer writing personal auto and household cover ran a claims operation where every claim followed one path: intake, manual triage, adjuster review, approval.

The adjusters were competent and busy; the queue was the constraint. Low-value, low-risk claims — the bulk of the book — waited behind the complex ones that genuinely needed human judgment. The work was being done properly. It was simply being done in the wrong order.

## 02. What We Found

Our diagnostic surfaced three compounding issues.

- 1. **Closed, never solved.** Incidents were resolved one by one; nothing linked recurring incidents to a common root cause, so problem management never happened.
- 2. **Major incidents run by hand.** A P1 meant manually spinning up a bridge, paging people and chasing updates — coordination lived in chat and memory.
- 3. **Routine tickets swamped the desk.** Password resets and how-do-I questions consumed analysts who should have been fixing the hard, recurring problems.

### 44 days

The average property claim cycle time has reached 44 days — the longest on record. Yet typical straight-through-processing rates still sit below 10%, while early adopters clear 20–30% of standard claims with no human touch. The gap isn't effort. It's triage.

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## 03. What We Did

We didn't start by making the form faster. We started by sorting the claims.

### Segment at intake

Claims land in Salesforce and are scored on risk and complexity the moment they arrive — before anyone touches them.

### Clear the simple ones

Low-risk claims passing every policy, eligibility and fraud gate auto-approve end to end. Anything flagged routes to an adjuster with the evidence attached.

### Keep customers informed

Automated status updates at every stage, so adjusters work claims instead of answering calls about them.

## 04. How We Rolled It Out

We were deliberate about what stays human. Straight-through processing is an operating model, not a rubber stamp: automation handles the routine decisions and adjusters handle judgment. Getting that boundary right is the whole engagement. We piloted on one line of business, proved the STP rate and settlement accuracy, then scaled — and we kept adjusters in the build, because they know exactly which claims should never clear themselves.

## 05. What An Engagement Like This Delivers

We started with a margin diagnostic across all three channels to quantify where money was escaping. Only then did we build.

~25%

### Claims straight through

Up from under 10%, with no human touch.

~45%

### Faster claim turnaround

Simple claims stopped queueing behind hard ones.

~30%

### Lower cost per claim

Manual effort concentrated where judgment is needed.

*The win wasn't a faster form. It was the simple claims clearing themselves — so people could work the hard ones.*

# Bring us the problem

No proposal until we understand the problem.